

SUPERIOR COURT OF CALIFORNIA
COUNTY OF MERCED

2260 N Street, Merced
627 W. 21st Street, Merced
1159 G Street, Los Banos

Tuesday, August 25, 2026

Tentative rulings are provided for the following courtrooms and assigned Judicial Officers with scheduled civil matters:

Courtroom 8 – Hon. Stephanie L. Jamieson

Courtroom 9 – Commissioner David Foster

Courtroom 12 – Hon. Jennifer O. Trimble

Parties who wish to appear remotely must contact the clerk of the court at (209) 725-4111 to seek permission and arrange for a remote appearance.

IMPORTANT: Court reporters will NOT be provided; parties must make their own arrangements. Electronic recording is available in certain courtrooms and may only be activated upon request.

The tentative rulings for specific calendars follow:

SUPERIOR COURT OF CALIFORNIA
COUNTY OF MERCED

Civil Law and Motion Tentative Rulings
Hon. Stephanie L. Jamieson
Courtroom 8

627 W. 21st Street, Merced

Tuesday, August 25, 2026
8:15 a.m.

The following tentative rulings shall become the ruling of the court unless a party gives notice of intention to appear as follows:

1. You must call (209) 725-4240 to notify the court of your intent to appear.
2. You must give notice to all other parties before 4:00 p.m. of your intent to appear.

Per California Rules of Court, rule 3.1308(a)(1), failure to do both items 1 and 2 will result in no oral argument. *Note:* Notifying CourtCall (the court's telephonic appearance provider) of your intent to appear does not satisfy the requirement of notifying the court.

Case No.	Title / Description
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23CV-00045	Larry Rubalcava, et al. vs Billy Cole, et al.
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Motions in Limine

Appearance required. The Court has received 9 motions in limine from Plaintiffs and 4 motions in limine from Defendants. The Court will rule on these motions at the hearing after addressing objections and hearing arguments from counsel. Jury trial is set for September 1, 2026, at 9:00 a.m. in Courtroom 8.

24CV-04181	Raman Johal vs Michelle Lim, et al.
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Order to Show Cause Dismissal

Appearance required. This matter was ordered transferred to Alameda County, pursuant to Defendant's motion to transfer venue on January 13, 2025. Plaintiff was ordered to pay the \$500.00 transfer fee. Plaintiff is ordered to appear and show cause why this matter should not be dismissed for failing to pay the transfer fee pursuant to this Court's order.

26CV-03793

Petition of: Tennie Robinson

Order to Show Cause Re: Name Change

Appearance required. Proof of publication was filed August 20, 2026. The Court has received no objections and found no legal grounds to deny the petition for name change. Accordingly, the petition will be GRANTED at the hearing.

26CV-03837

Petition of: Vincent Canal

Order to Show Cause Re: Name Change

Appearance required. Appear to address status of publication of the petition. No objections have been filed and the Court has found no legal grounds to deny the petition for name change.

SUPERIOR COURT OF CALIFORNIA
COUNTY OF MERCED

Civil Law and Motion/Petition Name Change
Hon. Jennifer O Trimble
Courtroom 12

1159 G Street, Los Banos

Tuesday, August 25, 2026
1:30 p.m.

The following tentative rulings shall become the ruling of the court unless a party gives notice of intention to appear as follows:

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Per California Rules of Court, rule 3.1308(a)(1), failure to do both items 1 and 2 will result in no oral argument. *Note:* Notifying CourtCall (the court's telephonic appearance provider) of your intent to appear does not satisfy the requirement of notifying the court.

Case No.	Title / Description
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23CV-01317	Mary Linda Ramirez vs. Roger Allen Paynter, Jr., et al.
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Hearing: Other

Appearance required.

Petition for Order Confirming Sale of Real Property

Appearance required.

23CV-02073	Synchrony Bank vs Mario Ramirez
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Motion for Entering Judgment

The motion for entering judgment is GRANTED.

The court will sign the order lodged with the court on May 18, 2026.

25CV-00450	Caroline Meraz vs. Hilda Gaona, et al.
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Order to Show Cause Re: Dismissal - Notice of Settlement

Appearance required.

25CV-04746

Sikh Gurdwara of Los Banos vs. Surjit Singh, et al

Motion Defendant Surjit Singh's Notice of Motion and Motion for Preliminary Injunction

The motion for preliminary injunction is DENIED.

Cross-Defendant's objection to the reply declarations submitted in support of the motion for preliminary injunction is SUSTAINED.

This court previously stated a judge should generally avoid issuing a preliminary injunction that does not maintain the status quo of the litigation until a trial on the merits. Granting the preliminary injunction would materially change the positions of the parties and would not maintain the status quo.

Further, Defendant still has not shown a probability of success. The evidence in this matter is disputed. The fact that additional evidence continues to be presented underscores the court's finding that the evidentiary record is not sufficiently developed at this stage of litigation for the court to make a determination as to probability of either party prevailing on the merits.

As before, the moving party is free to circulate the court's order to any members of the church who are allegedly being misled so that everyone will know that the final determination of that dispute will be decided by the court following a trial on the merits.

Accordingly, the motion is denied.

26CV-00012

Bruce Austin vs Infinity Management and Investments, LLC, et al.

Motion to Compel Further Responses to Special Interrogatories

The motion to compel further responses to Special Interrogatories, Set One, is DENIED.

As an initial matter, the motion is not untimely. The 45 day limitation in bringing a motion to compel further responses only relates to *verified responses* and not objection only responses.

Except as to Special Interrogatory No. 1, as with Plaintiff's prior motion to compel further responses, the accompanying separate statement fails to adhere to Rules of Court, rule 3.1345.

As for Special Interrogatory No. 1, the interrogatory contains multiple subparts in violation of Code of Civil Procedure section 2030.060, subdivision (f). Accordingly, the motion is denied.

Motion of Motion and Motion to Compel Further Responses to Requests for Admission

The motion to compel further responses to Requests for Admission, Set One, is DENIED.

The accompanying separate statement fails to adhere to Rules of Court, rule 3.1345. Although Plaintiff attempts to cure the deficiency on reply, it is untimely. Accordingly, the motion is denied.

Motion of Motion and Motion to Compel Further Responses to Request for Production of Documents

The motion to compel further responses to Request for Production, Set One, is GRANTED IN PART AND DENIED IN PART.

As an initial matter, the motion is not untimely. The 45 day limitation in bringing a motion to compel further responses only relates to *verified responses* and not objection only responses, or where no responses were given at all.

Plaintiff's motion to compel a further response to Request for Production, Set One, No. 1, is GRANTED. Defendant's objections are OVERRULED.

Plaintiff's motion to compel further responses to Request for Production, Set One, Nos. 2 through 20, is DENIED. The accompanying separate statement as to these requests fails to adhere to Rules of Court, rule 3.1345.

Plaintiff's motion to compel a further response to Request for Production, Set One, Nos. 21 through 25, is GRANTED. Plaintiff states Defendant failed to provide any response to these requests and Defendant in opposition does not dispute that contention.

Defendant is to provide further code-compliant, verified responses, to Requests for Production, Set One, No. 1, and Nos. 21 through 25, within fifteen (15) days of this court's order.

Monetary Sanctions

All requests for monetary sanctions is DENIED. Each party is successful and unsuccessful in bringing and opposing the motions.

26CV-00790

Mirastar Federal Credit Union vs Andrea Ketchum, et al.

Motion to Set Aside Default and Default Judgment

The motion to set aside default and default judgment is DENIED.

Service in this matter appears to be timely and proper and Defendants' motion does not disturb that determination. Further, as noted by the opposition, the proposed answer would not render a different result. In the proposed answer, Defendants admit all the statements of the complaint are true, with a noted exception that does not provide a defense to the complaint. Accordingly, the motion is denied.

26CV-04340

In the Matter of: Jesus Adrian Sepelveda Valdez

Hearing: Other Gun Violence Emergency Protective Order

Appearance required.

SUPERIOR COURT OF CALIFORNIA
COUNTY OF MERCED

Civil Unlawful Detainer
Hon. Jennifer O Trimble
Courtroom 12

1159 G Street, Los Banos

Tuesday, August 25, 2026
2:00 p.m.

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Case No.	Title / Description
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26CV-01765	[Parties' names withheld pursuant to CCP § 1161.2(a)(1)]
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Hearing: Other Claim of Right to Possession

Appearance required.